

Using LibreOffice to Increase Business Productivity

Business and productivity are two sides of the same coin. The use of open source software promotes productivity by removing several bottlenecks like vendor lock-in, the unnecessary expense when using proprietary software, issues involved in the maintenance of the software, etc. This article highlights the LibreOffice suite.



Businesses that restrict themselves to proprietary software like Microsoft Office get a raw deal. Not only do they have to pay for the software but they have to factor in the cost incurred every time the software becomes corrupt. This includes the fee to be paid to the computer technician to re-install the software. All this creates a vicious cycle, where costs and delays keep mounting. Ideally, every business should aim to develop a system that

automates maintenance to the maximum possible extent.

This is where open source software like LibreOffice, Apache OpenOffice, Scribus, GIMP, Inkscape, Firefox, Thunderbird, WordPress, VLC media player, etc, come in. Open source software is used in my company to the maximum extent possible, helping to streamline business processes. This practice makes updating the software and maintaining it very easy. The required software can be freely downloaded from

the Internet, and periodic updates can be easily applied by simply downloading the latest version of the software. With free and open source software (FOSS) anyone is licensed to use, copy, study and change the software in any way and the source code is openly shared; so people are encouraged to voluntarily improve the design of the software. This is in contrast to proprietary software, for which the software is under restrictive copyright and the source code is usually hidden from users.